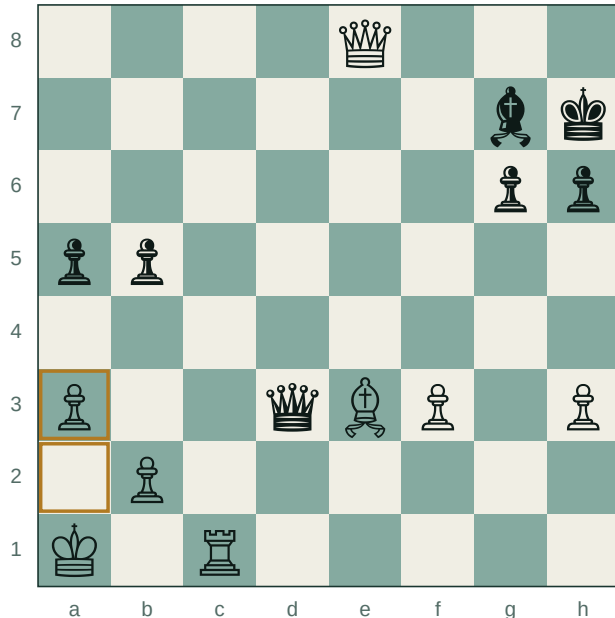


Pins and pressure: Black, move 37

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 37.a3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37...Qxa3+ 38. Kb1 Qxb2#

37...Qxa3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From a3 it attacks king on a1 and bishop on e3. Recorded reply: **38.Kb1**.

38...Qxb2# Mate: queen on b2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on b1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on b2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on a1. Absolute pin: pawn on b2.